

THE INTERN DIARIES

Intern Report

Top 10 Products

WEEK 3 | DAILY JOURNAL ENTRY



LEARNING BY DOING, ONE DAY AT A TIME

SuperStore (RETAIL COMMERCE)

1. Each row in Superstore is an order line, not an order. When you built the Top 10, what exactly did you sum, and why did you group by Product Name instead of Product ID?

Answer: I summed order lines into per-product totals with SUMIF / groupby, grouped by Product Name for readability, and verified the name→ID mapping wouldn't split a product's sales — because you rank at the grain the question demands.

2. You did this in Excel and Python. When the two tools disagree, which one do you trust, and how did you make sure they agreed here?

Answer: I trust neither by default; I made the two logically equivalent (SUMIF↔groupby, LARGE↔rank), compared names/values/order/ties, and treated a match as confirmation. Disagreements usually trace to dirty input (spaces, text-numbers), not the formula.

3. You've handed me a list of the 10 best-selling products. As a business owner, what do I do with this — and is 'best-selling by revenue' actually the same as 'best product'?

Answer: It tells me what to stock, promote, and watch — but revenue-leaders aren't automatically profit-leaders (my Day-16/Day-11 work showed discounts can make a top seller lose money), so I'd pair the list with profit and margin before calling any product "best".

4. How do you handle ties?

Answer: I first check whether the product at rank 10 has the same total sales as the product just below it. In Excel, I can do this using LARGE() to find the 10th largest sales value and COUNTIF() to see how many products match that value.

If there is a tie, I have two options: create a strict Top 10 using a documented tie-breaker, or create a Top 10 including ties so that all products with the same cutoff sales are shown.

For business analysis, I prefer including ties or at least documenting them, because excluding a product only due to sort order can be misleading.

5. Why use Top 10 analysis?

Answer: Top 10 analysis helps identify the most important contributors in a dataset. In sales, it shows which products generate the most revenue. This is useful because businesses often have limited inventory, marketing budget, and management attention. Knowing the top products helps prioritize stock planning, promotions, profitability review, and risk monitoring. It also helps check whether revenue is concentrated in a few products or spread across many.